

Success Is Simpler Than You Think

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 23, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/AJJBULRCUOA> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter argues that success is pure math — identify the leading indicators for your goal and hit them daily. Morning rituals, cold plunges, and biohacks are distractions from the only things that actually matter.

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Rejecting the Ritual Culture [0:00](#)

- Popular self-improvement culture pushes a long list of morning/lifestyle rituals as keys to success
 - Examples called out: waking up at 3:00 a.m., cold showers, red light therapy, no-fap, cold plunges, making your bed
- Carter's position: **"0% of that matters"**
 - These habits are "majoring in the minors" — spending energy on low-impact activities
- He labels this entire category "bro astrology" — the male equivalent of horoscope thinking
 - Implies it feels meaningful but has no real causal link to outcomes
- Calls out the popular aphorism "How you do anything is how you do everything" as "utter bullshit"
 - Counterpoint: some things genuinely don't require intense focus or effort — "Some shit just needs to get done. Some shit's not a big deal."

Success Is Just Math [0:22](#)

- Every major life goal reduces to a simple mathematical relationship between two variables

Goal	The Math
Get rich	Earn more than you spend; invest the difference
Lose weight	Burn more calories than you consume
Better family relationships	Spend more time with them

- No ritual, supplement, or biohack changes these underlying equations

Focus Only on Leading Indicators 1:09

- A "leading indicator" = the specific action that directly produces the desired outcome
- The entire framework in three steps:
 - Step 1 — Identify the leading indicators for your specific goal
 - Step 2 — Focus on them each day, relentlessly
 - Step 3 — Ignore everything else; nothing outside those indicators matters

"Once you find the leading indicators that accomplish your goals, you focus on them each day. Nothing else matters."